

Absolutely — **human** is a strong target because your passage uses it in **human stories**, where it means “stories centered on real people, emotions, motives, and lived experience,” while the wider family also covers **human beings as a species, humane/humanitarian contrasts, human error, human resources, human nature, and the noun human**.

Word family: **human / humans / humanity / humanise / humanised / humanisation / humane / inhuman / inhumane / humanitarian**

Base word: human

Plural noun: humans

Related forms: humanity, humanise, humanisation, humane, inhuman, inhumane, humanitarian

Useful compounds: human being, human nature, human error, human rights, human resources, human interest

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Instead, he made it feel like a series of **human stories**.”

Meaning in your passage: **human + story (人的經歷 / 情感) — 關於真實人物、情感和生活經驗的**

Here, **human** does not merely mean “not animal” or “belonging to Homo sapiens.”

It means:

> **focused on people as individuals — their emotions, motives, choices, struggles, relationships, and lived experience.**

繁體中文：

著重人的真實經歷、情感、動機、選擇和處境，而不是只呈現抽象資料或冷冰冰事實的

Natural translation:

> “He made it feel like a series of human stories.”

「他把歷史講得像一連串**關於真實人物、情感和人生經歷的故事**。」

So here:

> **human stories = 以人的經歷、情感和處境為核心的故事**

1. **human + noun (人類相關) — 人類的；人的**

This is the broad core adjective meaning.

Practice 1

> “The museum explores **human history**.”

「這間博物館探討**人類歷史**。」

Practice 2

> “Language is a fundamental part of **human culture**.”

「語言是**人類文化**的重要部分。」

human = 與人類、人的生活或人的活動有關的

Common:

- * human history
- * human behaviour
- * human society
- * human body
- * human culture

2. **human story/experience/interest (人的情感與經歷) — 充滿人情味的；以人的經歷為核心的**

This is your exact contextual branch.

Practice 3 — Original

> “He made history feel like a series of **human stories**.”

「他把歷史講得像一連串**關於真實人物和人生經歷的故事**。」

Practice 4

> “The documentary focuses on the **human experience** behind the statistics.”

「這部紀錄片集中呈現數據背後的**真實人生經歷**。」

Practice 5

> “The article gives the crisis a strong **human dimension**.”

「這篇文章突出危機中的**人性與真實生活層面**。」

human — experiential = 強調人的情感、經歷、關係和處境，而不是抽象數據或制度

3. **a human / humans** (名詞) — 人；人類個體

Now **human** is a noun.

Practice 6

> “Humans have always told stories.”

「**人類**一直都會講故事。」

Practice 7

> “The robot was designed to interact naturally with **humans**.”

「這個機械人被設計成能自然地與**人類**互動。」

human — noun = 一個人類個體；human(s) 可指人類成員

In ordinary speech, **person/people** is often warmer and more natural when referring to specific individuals.

4. **human being** (個體) — 人；人類

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 8

> “Every **human being** needs food and water.”

「每一個**人**都需要食物和水。」

Practice 9

> “He treated every student as a **human being**, not a number.”

「他把每個學生都當作一個**有感受的人**，而不是一個數字。」

human being = 一個人類個體，常用來強調人的基本身份、尊嚴或感受

5. **human = characteristic of ordinary people (人的局限 / 情感) — 人之常情的；有人性的**

A major figurative extension.

Practice 10

> “It is only **human** to make mistakes.”

「犯錯是**人之常情**。」

Practice 11

> “Feeling nervous before an interview is completely **human**.”

「面試前感到緊張完全是**很正常的人類反應 / 人之常情**。」

human = 符合一般人的情感、弱點或自然反應；人之常情的

This is not merely biological classification.

6. **human = warm / compassionate / personal (態度 / 方式) — 有人情味的；溫暖的**

A useful figurative sense.

Practice 12

> “The teacher had a very **human** way of speaking to students.”

「老師與學生說話的方式非常**有人情味、親切自然**。」

Practice 13

> “The company needs a more **human** approach to customer service.”

「這家公司在客戶服務方面需要一種更**有人情味、更重視人的方式**。」

human = 讓人感到有同理心、溫度和真實感，而不是冷漠、機械或制度化的

7. **human error (人為錯誤) — 由人造成的失誤**

A very important compound.

Practice 14

> “The accident was caused by **human error**.”

「事故是由**人為錯誤**造成的。」

Practice 15

> “The system is designed to reduce **human error**.”

「這個系統旨在減少**人為失誤**。」

human error = 由人的判斷、操作或注意力失誤所造成的錯誤，而非機器本身故障

8. **human nature (人性) — 人類普遍的心理 / 行為傾向**

Practice 16

> “Curiosity is part of **human nature**.”

「好奇心是**人性**的一部分。」

Practice 17

> “The novel explores both the good and bad sides of **human nature**.”

「這本小說探討**人性**的善惡兩面。」

human nature = 人類普遍具有的情感、慾望、傾向和行為特徵

9. **human rights (人權) — 每個人應有的基本權利**

Practice 18

> “The organisation works to protect **human rights**.”

「這個組織致力保障**人權**。」

Practice 19

> “Freedom of expression is often discussed as a **human right**.”

「言論自由常被視為一項**基本人權**來討論。」

human rights = 每個人因其人類身份而應享有的基本權利與自由

10. **human resources / HR (企業) — 人力資源；人事部門**

A major workplace/business meaning.

Practice 20

> “She works in **human resources**.”

「她在人力資源 / **人事部門**工作。」

Practice 21

> “Contact **HR** if you have questions about your contract.”

「如果你對合約有問題，請聯絡**人力資源部**。」

human resources = 與員工招聘、培訓、薪酬、政策和僱傭關係有關的企業職能

11. **human capital (經濟 / 商業) — 人力資本**

A useful academic/business compound.

Practice 22

> “Education increases a country’s **human capital**.”

「教育可以提升一個國家的**人力資本**。」

Practice 23

> “The company invests heavily in human capital.”

「公司大量投資於**員工能力和知識所構成的人力資本**。」

human capital = 人的知識、技能、經驗和能力所具有的經濟 / 生產價值

12. **human interest (新聞 / 媒體) — 人情味；以個人故事吸引人的**

A very useful media compound.

Practice 24

> “The report includes a strong **human-interest story**.”

「這份報道包含一個很有**人情味、聚焦個人經歷的故事**。」

Practice 25

> “The journalist added a human-interest angle to the article.”

「記者為文章加入了一個**以人物經歷和情感為焦點的角度**。」

human-interest = 透過真實人物、情感或個人處境引起讀者共鳴的

This is very close to your source phrase **human stories**.

13. **humanity = human beings collectively — 人類；全人類**

Practice 26

> “Climate change affects all of **humanity**.”

「氣候變化影響**全人類**。」

Practice 27

> “The invention changed the course of humanity.”

「這項發明改變了**人類歷史的進程**。」

humanity = 全體人類作為一個整體

14. **humanity = compassion / humane quality — 人性；仁慈；人道精神**

A genuinely different noun meaning.

Practice 28

> “She showed great **humanity** toward the victims.”

「她對受害者表現出極大的**同情和人道精神**。」

Practice 29

> “The story reminds us of our shared humanity.”

「這個故事提醒我們共同擁有的**人性與共通情感**。」

humanity = 對他人痛苦具有同情、關懷和尊重的特質；也可指人類共同的人性

15. **humanities (固定複數) — 人文學科**

An important academic lexicalized form.

Practice 30

> “He studied the **humanities** at university.”

「他在大學修讀**人文學科**。」

Practice 31

> “History is often grouped with the humanities.”

「歷史通常被歸入**人文學科**。」

the humanities = 研究人類文化、思想、歷史、語言、藝術等的學科領域

Common fields:

- * history
- * philosophy
- * literature
- * languages
- * classics

This is not simply “many humanities.”

16. **humanise = make something more human/personal/compassionate — 使更有人性 / 人情味**

A useful family extension.

Practice 32

> “Personal stories help **humanise** historical events.”

「個人故事有助把歷史事件**呈現得更有人情味、更貼近人的經歷**。」

Practice 33

> “The documentary humanises people who are often reduced to statistics.”

「這部紀錄片讓那些常被簡化成數字的人**重新被看見為有情感、有經歷的人**。」

humanise = 令某人 / 事物呈現出更多人的情感、個性、尊嚴或親切感

This is especially relevant to your passage.

17. **humanisation = process of making something more human/personal — 人性化；增加人情味**

Practice 34

> “The campaign called for the **humanisation** of public services.”

「這項運動呼籲公共服務更加**人性化**。」

Practice 35

> “The humanisation of the story made it more memorable.”

「故事被賦予更多**人情味和人的角度**後，變得更令人難忘。」

humanisation = 令制度、故事、服務等更重視人的情感、尊嚴和真實經驗的過程

18. **humane = compassionate and avoiding unnecessary suffering — 仁慈的；人道的**

This is extremely important because learners often confuse **human** and **humane**.

Practice 36

> “Animals should be treated in a **humane** way.”

「動物應該受到**人道、仁慈的對待**。」

Practice 37

> “They are looking for a more humane solution.”

「他們正在尋找一個更**人道、更體恤人的解決方法**。」

****humane = 對人 / 動物有同情心，盡量避免不必要痛苦的****

19. **inhuman = not human / lacking normal human qualities — 非人的；不像人的**

This has two common branches.

Practice 38

> “The creature looked almost **inhuman**.”

「那個生物看起來幾乎**不像人類 / 非人的**。」

Practice 39

> “The workload was almost **inhuman**.”

「那種工作量幾乎**超出一般人能承受的程度**。」

****inhuman = 不屬於人類，或程度極端得不像正常人能做到 / 承受的****

20. **inhumane = cruel / lacking compassion — 不人道的；殘忍的**

Very important contrast.

Practice 40

> “The prisoners were kept in **inhumane conditions**.”

「囚犯被關在**不人道、惡劣的環境**中。」

Practice 41

> “The treatment of the animals was clearly **inhumane**.”

「那些動物受到的待遇明顯**不人道 / 殘忍**。」

inhumane = 缺乏同情心、造成不必要痛苦或嚴重違反人道原則的

21. **humanitarian** = concerned with reducing suffering / helping people — 人道主義的；救援性的

A major modern family member.

Practice 42

> “The organisation provides **humanitarian aid**.”

「這個組織提供**人道援助**。」

Practice 43

> “Thousands of people needed humanitarian assistance after the disaster.”

「災害後，數千人需要**人道救援**。」

humanitarian = 以保護生命、減輕痛苦和援助有需要的人為目的的

Common:

- * humanitarian aid
- * humanitarian crisis
- * humanitarian assistance
- * humanitarian organisation

Important distinction: **human vs humane**

This is the biggest family trap.

human

= related to people/humankind

- > human body
- > human history
- > human error

humane

= compassionate, kind, avoiding suffering

- > humane treatment

So:

- > **human treatment**

could simply mean treatment involving humans.

- > **humane treatment**

means **人道的待遇**.

Important distinction: **inhuman vs inhumane**

inhuman

can mean:

- * not human;
- * beyond normal human capacity;
- * lacking ordinary human qualities.

inhumane

specifically means:

- * cruel;
- * lacking compassion;
- * causing unnecessary suffering.

Compare:

> **inhuman strength**

> = 非人的 / 超常人的力量

> **inhumane treatment**

> = 不人道的待遇

This is excellent MCQ material.

Important distinction: **human vs person**

human

emphasizes biological/species or general human qualities.

person

means an individual human being in ordinary social/legal use.

> “Three people were waiting outside.”

is more natural than:

> “Three humans were waiting outside.”

Humans can sound scientific, contrastive, or impersonal in everyday contexts.

Important distinction: **human vs people**

people

normal everyday plural for persons.

humans

often used when discussing:

- * humanity as a species;
- * humans versus animals/robots;
- * scientific/general statements.

> “People in the room were quiet.”

> “Humans need social connection.”

Different register and focus.

Important distinction: **human vs mankind / humankind**

humankind

= all human beings collectively.

humanity

also can mean all humans.

mankind

traditional term for humanity, but **humankind / humanity** are often preferred in modern inclusive usage.

Important distinction: **humanity vs humans**

humans

= individual members of the species collectively.

humanity

= humankind as a whole, or compassion/humaneness.

> “Humans developed language.”

> “The future of humanity.”

The second has a more collective/abstract feel.

Important distinction: **humanity vs humanities**

humanity

= humankind / compassion

the humanities

= academic disciplines about human culture and thought

> humanity = 人類 / 人性

> humanities = 人文學科

One letter changes the lexical category substantially.

Important distinction: **human story vs human-interest story**

human story

broad:

a story centered on people and their experiences.

human-interest story

media term:

a story designed to engage readers through personal/emotional experience.

Your passage means the broader first idea, though the two are closely related.

Important distinction: **human error vs machine error**

human error

= mistake caused by human judgment/operation.

machine/system error

= failure caused by equipment/software/system malfunction.

This distinction is especially common in:

* aviation

* medicine

* engineering

* technology

Important distinction: **human resources vs workforce**

human resources

can mean:

1. employees considered as organisational resources;
2. the HR department/function.

workforce

= the actual body of workers employed/available.

> “HR introduced a new policy.”

> “The company reduced its workforce.”

Not interchangeable.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **human — related to humanity** = 人類的 / 人的
- * **human story/experience** = 以人的真實經歷、情感和處境為核心
- * **a human / humans** = 人類個體 / 人類
- * **human being** = 人
- * **human — ordinary human reaction** = 人之常情
- * **human — warm/personal** = 有人情味的
- * **human error** = 人為錯誤
- * **human nature** = 人性
- * **human rights** = 人權
- * **human resources** = 人力資源 / 人事部門
- * **human capital** = 人力資本
- * **human interest** = 人情味 / 人物故事角度
- * **humanity — humankind** = 全人類
- * **humanity — compassion** = 人道精神 / 人性
- * **humanities** = 人文學科
- * **humanise** = 使更人性化 / 有人情味
- * **humanisation** = 人性化過程
- * **humane** = 仁慈 / 人道的
- * **inhuman** = 非人的 / 超出常人程度的
- * **inhumane** = 不人道 / 殘忍的

* **humanitarian** = 人道主義 / 救援相關的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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human — general adjective	與人類、人的生活或人的活動有關的
human story/experience	著重人的真實經歷、情感、動機和處境，而非抽象資料的
a human / humans	一個 / 多個人類個體
human being	一個人類個體，常強調基本身份、尊嚴或感受
human — ordinary reaction	符合一般人的情感、弱點或自然反應；人之常情的
human — warm/personal	具有同理心、溫度和真實感，而不是冷漠機械的
human error	由人的判斷、操作或注意力失誤造成的錯誤
human nature	人類普遍具有的情感、慾望、傾向和行為特徵
human rights	每個人因其人類身份而應享有的基本權利與自由
human resources	與員工招聘、培訓、政策和僱傭關係有關的企業職能 / 部門
human capital	人的知識、技能、經驗和能力所具有的經濟價值
human interest	透過人物經歷、情感和處境引起共鳴的媒體角度
humanity — humankind	全體人類作為一個整體
humanity — compassion	對他人痛苦具有同情、關懷和尊重的人道特質
humanities	研究人類文化、思想、歷史、語言和藝術的人文學科
humanise	令某人 / 某事物呈現更多人的情感、尊嚴和真實經驗
humanisation	令制度、服務、故事等更重視人的需要與感受的過程
humane	對人或動物有同情心、盡量避免不必要痛苦的
inhuman	不屬於人類，或極端得超出正常人類程度的
inhumane	缺乏同情、造成不必要痛苦或違反人道原則的
humanitarian	以保護生命、減輕痛苦和援助有需要人士為目的的

For your original sentence

> “Instead, he made it feel like a series of **human stories**.”

The exact meaning is:

****human = 著重真實人物的情感、選擇、動機、關係和生活處境，而不是把歷史只當成抽象資料****

So:

> ****human stories****

= ****「關於真實人物、情感和人生經歷的故事」****

Natural full translation:

> **「相反地，他把歷史講得像一連串關於真實人物、情感和人生經歷的故事。」**

The key contrast in the paragraph is beautifully clear:

> **names and dates** → 冷冰冰的資料

> **human stories** → 有人物、有情感、有選擇、有處境的真實人生故事

That contrast is exactly why **human** is doing much more work here than simply meaning 「人類的」.